FETTUCCINE ALFREDO

SERVES	TOTAL TIME
4-6	**1 h plus the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Egg dough
104 g	Unsalted buffalo's milk butter, cold and cubed
52 g	Unsalted cow's milk butter, cold and cubed
50 grinds	Black pepper
231 g	2-year parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
120 g	5-year parmigiano-reggiano, coarsely grated

METHOD

1. Roll and cut 624 g of fettuccine from the egg dough.
2. Fill a large pot with water, salt it heavily and bring it to the boil over high heat.
3. Set a large sauté pan over low heat, then ladle in 2 to 3 ladles of the pot water, 115 to 170 g. Add both butters and swirl the pan until they emulsify. Grind in the pepper and stir it through.
4. Boil the fettuccine 1 to 2 minutes. It wants to be tender, not soft.
5. Move the pasta across with tongs or a pasta basket, raise the heat to medium and toss for 1 to 2 minutes. Add another 2 to 3 ladles of pasta water, 115 to 170 g, and keep tossing to marry.
6. Pull the pan off the heat and add the finely grated 2-year parmigiano a little at a time, tossing as it goes. If the sauce tightens, a splash of pasta water loosens it.
7. Divide between bowls, then finish with the 5-year parmigiano, grated coarsely, and more pepper.

NOTES

> The two butters do separate jobs. Buffalo's milk brings a tang, cow's milk carries the emulsion. All cow's milk butter still makes a good dish.
> The 5-year parmigiano is the cutting note that plain Alfredo lacks. Any wheel aged at least two years will stand in.
> Grate the finishing cheese coarsely, so the crystals land as crunch instead of melting away.
> Pasta water goes into the pan before the pasta does, so the butter has something to emulsify into from the start.

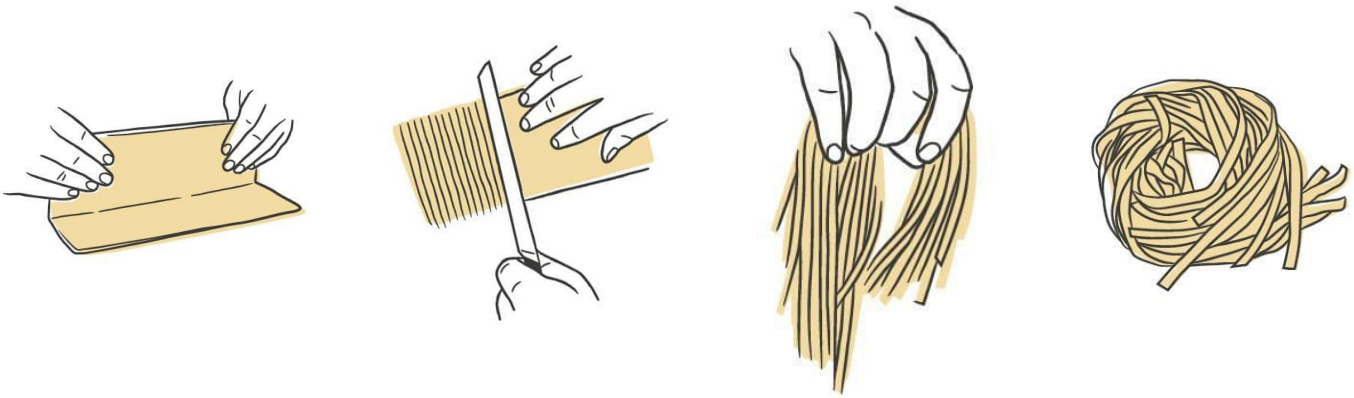
SHAPE
Fettuccine

Region: Central Italy, mainly Lazio / Rest: 20-30 min at room temperature

METHOD

1. Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Give a wooden work surface a light dusting of 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Knife the sheets into 18-inch lengths and trim the ragged edges off. Save the trim for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic or a towel while you work.
4. Fit the fettuccine cutter to a hand-crank machine or the KitchenAid attachment.
5. Hold one end of a sheet, feed the other end into the cutter, and crank steadily, keeping the sheet close to perpendicular to the rollers. Catch the strands underneath with your free hand.
6. Dust the cut strands generously with 00 flour and shake them apart. Coil the batch into a nest on the pan.
7. Repeat with the rest of the sheets.
8. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature.
9. To hold, cover the pan with plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



1 2 3 4

NOTES

To cut by hand instead of by machine: fold a sheet in half, then in thirds, into a packet roughly 4 1/2 by 6 inches. Turn it so the long side faces you, trim the ends, then slice 1/4-inch strips working inward from one edge. Rejoin the method at the dusting step.
Hand-cut width is 1/4 inch. The book gives no separate figure for the machine cutter.
Rolled to the same thinness as tagliatelle in this book. The two are told apart by width and by cut: fettuccine narrower and straight-edged, tagliatelle wider and fluted.
Coiled into a nest rather than a horseshoe.
Refrigerated shelf life is 24 hours.
Served with butter, parmigiano, and black pepper, never cream, plus whatever vegetables or pantry items are on hand.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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